Neffke, Otto and Weyh (2017) study whether worker mobility can be used to measure skill relatedness between industries. They argue that workers are more likely to move between industries that require similar skills, and use German employment data to show that labour flows provide a better measure of skill relatedness than traditional measures such as co-location or input-output linkages. They also find that this measure helps predict regional industry entry and employment growth.

Straulino et al. (2023) extend Neffke et al. by using labour-flow-based skill relatedness to study regional connectivity. They show that access to skill-related workers in neighbouring cities, taking travel time into account, is associated with local employment growth.

Elekes et al. (2023) extend Neffke et al. by applying labour-flow-based skill relatedness to individual career paths rather than industries. They find that low-wage workers are more likely to move into higher-paid jobs when more skill-related, higher-paying opportunities are available in their local labour market.

Previous research shows that regions tend to diversify into industries that are related to their existing economic structure. Accessibility has also been shown to increase access to skill-related labour pools in neighbouring regions. However, less is known about whether accessibility helps regions develop new industries that are related to their existing skill base. This matters because transport connections may influence not only access to workers, but also long-term regional economic diversification.

Research question: Does better accessibility to regions with skill-related industries increase the likelihood that a Hungarian region develops those industries?

The study could use an existing skill-relatedness matrix or, if suitable Hungarian linked employer-employee data are accessible, construct a Hungary-specific measure based on worker flows between industries. This could be combined with KSH employment data by industry at the smallest available regional level, potentially districts or counties, and available measures of accessibility or mobility between regions, such as regional transport infrastructure improvements from KSH data, modelled road travel times using OpenStreetMap, or public transport accessibility based on MÁV GTFS data. The analysis would examine whether regions are more likely to develop new industries when skill-related industries are present in more accessible neighbouring regions. The findings could support regional development agencies and transport planners by showing whether improved connectivity may support regional economic diversification.